

Gender Bender

Investment ideas often come from general reading, and I was struck in 1991 by how much I was reading, in my family newspaper, about sex. It was at that time that the media were busy providing us with lurid anecdotes about Mike Tyson and Desiree Washington, Bill Clinton and Gennifer Flowers, and Clarence Thomas and Anita Hill, as well as clinical details about William Kennedy Smith and Patricia Bowman, a sad story about Magic Johnson and a whole flock of chicks, and a pathetic story about Pee-Wee Herman all by himself.

In all the titillating discussion of sexual harassment in work situations, date rape, condom distribution in schools, abortion, and sexually transmitted diseases, I noted that one important sexual issue had been lost sight of: What does sex do for investors? Does gender matter in the stock market? Might there be a pattern here whose recognition would lead to an investment opportunity?

Our Quantitative Analysis Department went to work and came up with thirteen boy-name stocks and thirteen girl-name stocks.

BOY STOCKS

Clinton Gas System
Thomas Industries
Smith International
Harman International¹
Magic Circle
Johnson Products
Tyson Foods

GIRL STOCKS

Flowers Industries
Santa Anita Realty
Hills Department Stores
Bowmar Instrument²
NUI Corp.³
Claire's Stores
Juno Lighting